PRACTICE EXAM 12 / EXAM SET 02

Domain 5: Administrative Assisting

12 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

> **SCENARIO** A provider is running 25 minutes behind schedule. The clinical team has confirmed that three waiting patients have routine visits and has given the front desk the updated estimate. Office policy allows patients to keep their appointment or reschedule without a late-cancellation charge when the clinic causes the delay.

How should the medical assistant manage the waiting-room schedule?

A. Move each waiting patient to another provider without checking that provider's schedule.
B. Keep the original appointment times on display and wait for patients to ask about delays.
C. Share the updated wait estimate and offer the permitted choice of waiting or rescheduling.
D. Shorten each remaining visit to recover the delay without consulting the clinical team.

Q02 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

> **SCENARIO** An approved authorization for an elective imaging study lists North Imaging as the service location. The patient asks to have the same study at South Imaging instead. The payer's written instructions state that an authorization is valid only at its listed location and that a location change must be approved before service. Both locations have openings next week.

What should the assistant do before confirming the requested change?

A. Request a location change through the payer's process and verify its approval.
B. Transfer the existing authorization number to South Imaging without contacting the payer.
C. Tell South Imaging to submit the claim under North Imaging's location information.
D. Change the location name on the saved approval letter and retain the same approval.

Q03 | Coding Billing and Payments

SCENARIO A completed office-visit note lists two different diagnoses for the same treated problem, and the provider's final diagnosis is unclear. The charge-entry worksheet requires the diagnosis supported by that encounter. Office policy directs staff to route unresolved documentation questions to the provider through the coding team before releasing the claim.

Which action best supports accurate claim preparation?

A. Select the diagnosis associated with the higher expected reimbursement.

B. Carry forward the diagnosis from the patient's last visit.

C. Choose a diagnosis by interpreting the test results in the chart.

D. Hold the affected claim and route the discrepancy for provider clarification.

Q04 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO The supply room has three cartons of the same disposable examination supplies. Carton 1 was received first and expires in June 2027. Carton 2 was received second and expires in April 2027. Carton 3 arrived today and expires in May 2027. All are intact and unexpired. Office policy uses first-expiring, first-out rotation.

Which carton should be placed at the front for use first?

A. Carton 1, because it was received first.

B. Carton 3, because it arrived most recently.

C. Carton 2, because it has the earliest expiration date.

D. Carton 1, because it has the latest expiration date.

Q05 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

SCENARIO At checkout after a visit on November 5, 2026, the provider orders a routine follow-up exactly four weeks later. For this order, four weeks means 28 calendar days. The patient can attend any of the listed dates, and the provider has an appropriate opening on each.

Which date matches the ordered follow-up interval?

A. November 12, 2026

B. November 26, 2026

C. December 10, 2026

D. December 3, 2026

Q06 | Coding Billing and Payments

SCENARIO A cashier starts with $120 in the cash drawer. During the shift, three cash payments of $35, $40, and $25 are received and recorded correctly. There are no refunds, deposits, change errors, or other drawer transactions. The end-of-shift count is $210. Office policy requires staff to recount a discrepancy and notify the supervisor if it remains.

Which reconciliation finding and action are correct?

A. $10 short; recount the drawer and report a persistent discrepancy.
B. $10 over; record the difference as an additional patient payment.
C. $90 short; remove the opening cash balance from the receipts.
D. $110 over; compare the drawer only with the cash received this shift.

Q07 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO An older adult is completing the clinic's previsit telehealth test. The camera preview works, but the microphone test says "Microphone access blocked for this site." The clinic's approved troubleshooting card directs patients with this message to allow microphone access for the verified clinic visit page and then repeat the test.

Which instruction follows the approved troubleshooting process?

A. Allow microphone access for the clinic visit page and repeat the audio test.
B. Restart the camera preview without changing the microphone setting.
C. Create a second portal account and schedule another telehealth visit.
D. Cancel the appointment because a blocked microphone cannot be corrected.

Q08 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

SCENARIO A patient is enrolled in two commercial health plans. Both policies are current, but a claim is pending because the payer needs updated coordination-of-benefits information to determine which plan pays first. The payer requests a patient-completed coverage questionnaire. Office policy assigns follow-up on this request to the insurance specialist.

Which action helps resolve the pending claim?

A. List whichever plan has the lower deductible as primary.
B. Remove the second policy from the account to simplify processing.
C. Submit a duplicate claim to both plans marked as the primary payer.
D. Help the patient access the questionnaire and route follow-up to the insurance specialist.

Q09 | Scheduling and Patient Flow

SCENARIO A routine follow-up appointment becomes available after a cancellation. Two patients are on the approved waitlist for that same visit type, and both can attend the opening. Patient Lee joined the list on Monday; patient Morgan joined on Wednesday. Office policy offers openings in waitlist-entry order, records the response, and moves to the next person only after a decline. Neither patient has been contacted yet.

Which scheduling action follows the waitlist policy?

A. Offer the opening to both patients and book whoever responds first.
B. Offer the opening to Lee and record the response before moving to Morgan.
C. Offer the opening to Morgan because the request was received more recently.
D. Book Lee automatically and notify the patient after the appointment is assigned.

Q10 | Coding Billing and Payments

SCENARIO For a covered office service, the practice charged $210 and the contracted allowed amount is $150. The final remittance assigns $120 to the insurer and $30 to the patient. The office contract explicitly requires the difference between the charge and the allowed amount to be posted as a contractual adjustment rather than charged to the patient. No payment has yet been posted.

What amount should be posted as the contractual adjustment?

A. $30
B. $90
C. $180
D. $60

Q11 | Records Office Systems and Supplies

SCENARIO A work-status form arrives in the office correspondence queue for a patient seen yesterday. The form requires the treating provider to document any work restrictions and sign it. Office policy directs the assistant to match the form to the patient and encounter, route it to the treating provider, and track its pending status. The form is due tomorrow.

How should the assistant process the form?

A. Fill in restrictions based on the appointment reason and send the unsigned form.
B. Route the matched form to the treating provider and record its due date for tracking.
C. Copy restrictions from an older form and insert the provider's name as the signature.
D. File the blank form as completed because the patient was seen yesterday.

Q12 | Insurance and Prior Authorization

What makes a provider part of a particular health plan's network?

A. The provider has a license to practice in the patient's state.

B. The provider accepts the patient's preferred payment method.

C. The provider has a contract to participate with that health plan.

D. The provider receives a referral from the patient's primary care office.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

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01 C	02 A	03 D	04 C	05 D	06 A
07 A	08 D	09 B	10 D	11 B	12 C

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: C

Share the updated wait estimate and offer the permitted choice of waiting or rescheduling.

The assistant can use the clinical team's confirmed estimate and the stated office options to help patients make informed scheduling choices. Any accepted change should be entered in the schedule. Shortening visits or moving patients to another provider requires coordination rather than a unilateral front-desk decision.

Q02 | Correct answer: A

Request a location change through the payer's process and verify its approval.

The payer's supplied rule makes the location part of the approval, so the assistant must obtain and verify the approved change before confirming the transfer. The original authorization cannot simply be reused at a different location. Altering a saved letter would not change the payer's actual authorization record.

Q03 | Correct answer: D

Hold the affected claim and route the discrepancy for provider clarification.

The claim must reflect the provider's documented diagnosis, and the stated policy supplies a process for resolving the conflicting note. The assistant should hold the affected claim and route the question rather than choose a diagnosis independently. Neither a previous diagnosis nor expected payment resolves the current documentation conflict.

Q04 | Correct answer: C

Carton 2, because it has the earliest expiration date.

First-expiring, first-out rotation places the April 2027 carton ahead of the May and June cartons. The supplied policy bases the order on expiration rather than delivery date. Using the oldest delivery first would overlook that a later shipment expires sooner.

Q05 | Correct answer: D

December 3, 2026

Four weeks is 4 x 7 = 28 calendar days, and November 5 plus 28 days is December 3, 2026. November 12 is one week later, November 26 is three weeks later, and December 10 is five weeks later. The assistant should schedule the interval actually ordered.

Q06 | Correct answer: A

$10 short; recount the drawer and report a persistent discrepancy.

Expected drawer cash is $120 + $35 + $40 + $25 = $220. The actual $210 is $10 short, so the assistant should recount and follow the reporting policy if the shortage persists. Both the opening cash and the shift receipts belong in the drawer reconciliation.

Q07 | Correct answer: A

Allow microphone access for the clinic visit page and repeat the audio test.

The displayed message identifies microphone permission as the specific issue, and the approved card states the corresponding correction. The assistant should guide the patient through that step and confirm the repeat test result. Camera testing or a second account would not address the blocked microphone setting.

Q08 | Correct answer: D

Help the patient access the questionnaire and route follow-up to the insurance specialist.

The payer has identified the information needed to determine payment order. Helping the patient complete the requested process and involving the designated specialist addresses that missing information. Deductible size does not establish which plan pays first, and deleting valid coverage would make the account inaccurate.

Q09 | Correct answer: B

Offer the opening to Lee and record the response before moving to Morgan.

Lee joined first, so the stated policy requires offering the opening to Lee and recording the response. An offer is not the same as a confirmed appointment. Simultaneous offers or automatic booking would bypass the required offer-and-response process.

Q10 | Correct answer: D

$60

The contractual adjustment is the charge minus the allowed amount: $210 - $150 = $60. The remaining allowed amount is accounted for by the insurer's $120 and the patient's $30. Subtracting only the insurer payment would mix patient responsibility with the contractual adjustment.

Q11 | Correct answer: B

Route the matched form to the treating provider and record its due date for tracking.

This correspondence requires provider completion, so the assistant should route it to the treating provider and track the deadline under the stated policy. Matching it to the correct encounter supplies administrative context without deciding restrictions. A recent visit does not mean the form has been completed or authorized.

Q12 | Correct answer: C

The provider has a contract to participate with that health plan.

A network is made up of providers, facilities, and suppliers that have contracted with the health plan. A professional license or a referral does not establish participation in a particular plan. Network status should be considered for the specific plan rather than inferred from a payment method.

End of Practice Exam